UNGRADED PRACTICE

STAR(T) Practice: Your Choice

The fourth story is yours. Pick the skill you can tell the most honest story about.

Three of your four stories are assigned. This one is yours to choose. Pick the skill that connects most honestly to a real experience, from this course or from your life before college. The best choice is the one where you have the most specific, honest thing to say, not the one that sounds most impressive.

This is practice, and it isn't graded. Draft your story here, then record it or copy it into the matching STAR(T) Stories portal in Blackboard.

Two ways to use this handout. It matches the Your Choice Practice Guide in the STAR(T) Stories Guide. Print it and fill it in by hand, or type in the boxes below and save a PDF. Aim for a story that runs 2 to 4 minutes out loud.

NAME _____ **DATE** _____

STEP 0

Choose your skill

Read through the options and pick the one you can tell the most specific, honest story about.

My chosen skill

- ☐ **#1 Communication**
  Listening carefully, responding clearly, and writing or speaking in ways that actually land.
- ☐ **#2 Critical & Creative Thinking**
  Evaluating information carefully, questioning assumptions, or finding a new approach to a real problem.
- ☐ **#3 Quantitative Reasoning**
  Using numbers, data, or calculations to understand a situation and make a better decision.
- ☐ **#4 Interpersonal Relations**
  Handling relationships thoughtfully: understanding other perspectives, building trust, or working through conflict respectfully.
- ☐ **#7 Civic Engagement**
  Taking action in your community and contributing to something beyond yourself.
- ☐ **#8 Collaboration & Teamwork**
  Working well with others: contributing to a team, sharing the work, and building toward a shared goal.
- ☐ **#10 Information Literacy**
  Finding, evaluating, and using information responsibly, and knowing what to trust before you act on it.

Why I chose it, in one or two sentences. Your submission starts with this.

The experience I'm going to use

S Situation

Set the scene. What was going on?

> Give just enough context for someone who wasn't there. Two or three sentences is usually plenty.

Watch out: The Situation is the setup, not the story. Get to the Task quickly.

T Task

Define your role. What was yours to do?

> What were you trying to do or solve, and what part of it was yours?

Watch out: Your Task is what you were responsible for, not the group's general goal.

A Action

Show what you did, step by step.

This is the most important step. Use "I": I decided, I reached out, I chose. Describe the specific things you did and the choices you made. This is where your skill lives. Show it, don't just claim it.

Watch out: "We figured it out" hides your part. Describe what you did, even inside a group effort.

R Result

Name the outcome. What happened because of what you did?

What changed or got resolved because of what you did? Be specific.

Watch out: "It went well" isn't a result. Name what specifically happened.

T Transfer

Connect it forward. What does this mean for what comes next?

> Where will this skill show up next? Name a program, a kind of work, a relationship, or a responsibility where it will matter.

> *Watch out: "This will help me in the future" isn't a Transfer. Name a specific place, role, or situation.*

AFTER YOU DRAFT IT

Quick reflection

Which step was hardest to write, and why do you think that is?

Does anything sound generic, like anyone could have written it? Where could you be more specific?